

Bedtime Tales

# Tessa the Shy Tortoise



KIDS BOOK VIDEOS

Tessa was a little tortoise who was very shy. New places made her tuck right into her shell.

One day there was a party at the pond, and all the pond animals were invited. Tessa felt shy — her feet felt slow and her voice felt tiny.

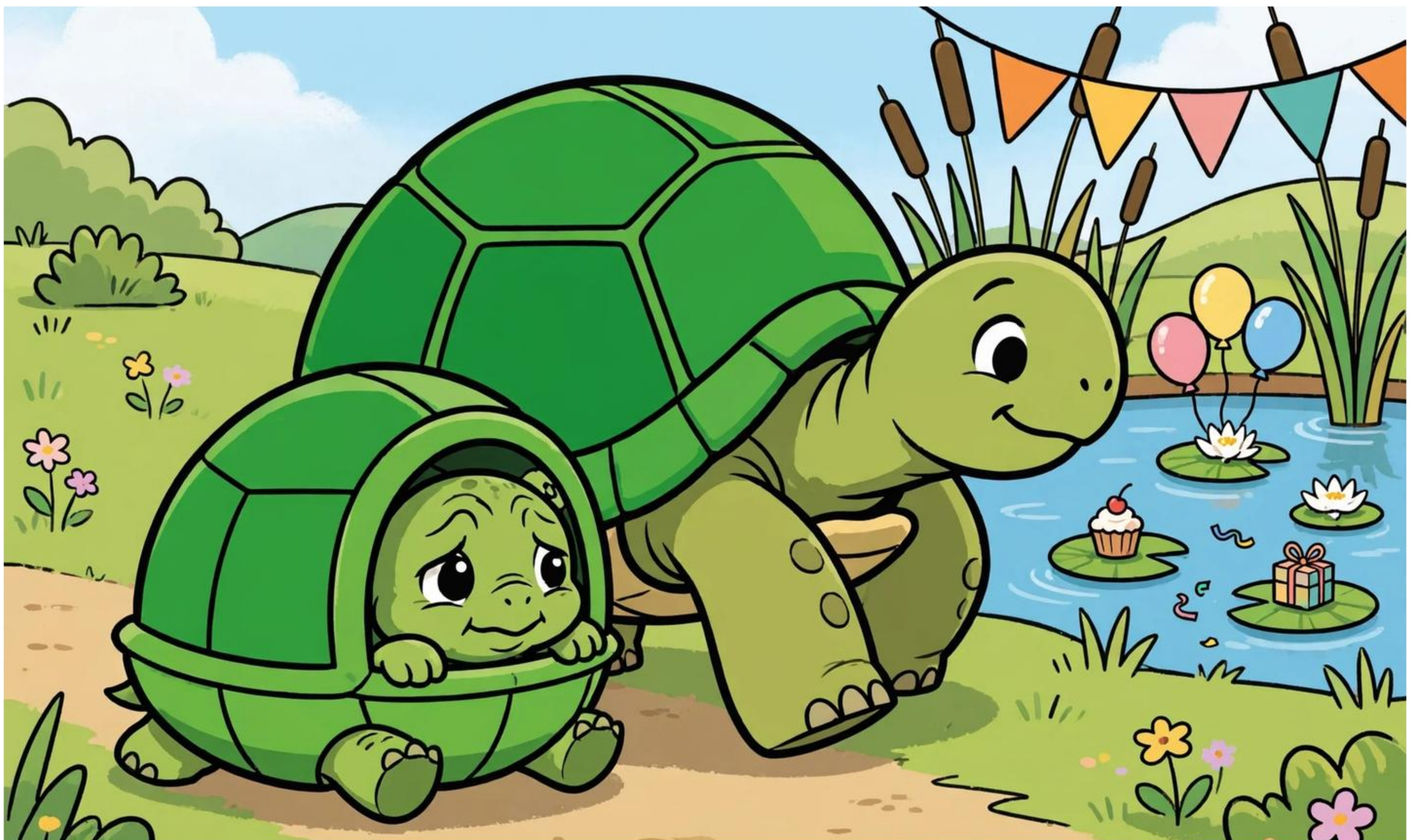
"What if no one talks to me?" she worried.

Mama Tortoise walked with her to the pond. "I see you feel shy," she said.

Tessa nodded.

"It is okay to feel shy," Mama said. "Being shy just means you warm up slowly."

Tessa liked that. Warm up slowly — like sunshine on her shell.



At the pond, music was playing while frogs hopped and ducks danced. Tessa tucked her head in a little. Then she saw a small frog sitting all alone. He looked shy too.

Tessa took one slow step... then another slow step.

"Hello," she said in her tiny voice.

"Hello," said the frog. "My name is Remy."

"I am Tessa," said Tessa.



They sat together by the water, watching the dancers and sharing some lettuce. Remy told a funny joke, and Tessa giggled. Her shell felt warm, and her voice felt a little bigger.

They played a slow game of bubbles.

One bubble.

Two bubbles.

Three bubbles.

Pop!



Tessa felt happy. She had made a friend!

Mama Tortoise smiled from far away. She whispered, "You did it, my brave girl."

That night, Tessa snuggled into her soft moss bed, thinking about Remy and the bubbles. The shyness of the afternoon had melted into something proud and warm.

The pond sang its night song — croak, croak, hush. Tessa closed her eyes.

She was cozy. She was loved.

Goodnight, Tessa.



Shy is okay — one small hello can  
grow into a friend.

The End

